

Global bond flows compass

Tactical inflows into EM as yields fall

Fixed Income Rates

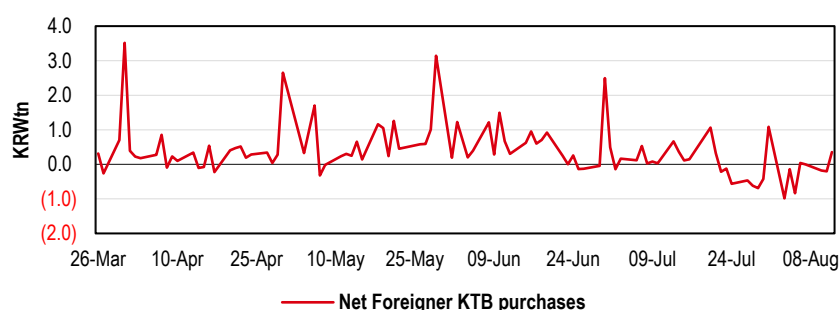
Global

- ◆ Broad-based EM inflows look tactical, not structural
- ◆ With US CPI in line and summer liquidity thin, inflows should remain steady but headline-sensitive
- ◆ Hedging costs are the swing factor in foreign demand for KTBs

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Chart of the week: Foreigners have been net selling KTBs since end of July



Source: KTBInfo, HSBC

Figure 1. Monthly trends in offshore bond flows of EM sovereign debt

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	25-Aug	25-Sep	25-Oct	25-Nov	25-Dec	26-Jan	26-Feb	26-Mar	26-Apr	26-May	26-Jun	26-Jul	26-Aug
CNY	-23.9	-1.2	-32.4	-7.5	1.3	-2.0	-0.8	5.4	-2.3	-2.9	-3.0	2.8	-7.6	-1.4	9.0	1.6		
KRW	4.7	16.0	13.0	43.2	10.7	-0.2	1.1	0.6	11.5	3.9	2.7	5.4	-5.9	2.3	6.2	3.0		
CZK	4.0	15.9	-6.8	-0.6	3.8	0.6	0.0	-0.3	3.0	-1.5	2.9	1.6	-0.9	2.2	-2.0	0.8		
PEN	-1.9	-0.3	3.3	3.7	2.0	0.6	0.1	0.4	-0.0	-0.3	0.3	0.7	-0.3	0.6	0.4	0.3	0.4	
ILS	-1.9	3.6	-2.8	3.8	1.5	-0.3	-0.1	1.5	0.9	0.5	0.7	-0.9	-0.1	1.2	0.6			
COP	4.8	-2.5	-1.0	15.8	-2.5	0.8	8.0	-0.6	0.4	7.0	0.3	2.3	-1.8	-3.6	-1.2	1.4		
HUF	2.7	2.0	-2.5	2.4	13.6	2.1	0.2	1.2	0.8	-5.1	6.9	0.7	-2.3	2.8	2.9	2.1	0.4	
MYR	-1.8	5.4	0.5	4.5	0.3	0.8	-1.5	0.8	1.0	0.5	0.4	-0.2	0.8	0.0	-1.7	1.0		
THB	0.8	-2.5	-1.7	1.5	0.7	-0.3	0.1	1.1	0.3	-0.3	1.3	-0.1	-0.3	0.3	0.5	-0.6	-0.3	0.3
PLN	4.9	-3.2	4.1	6.7	8.8	1.3	-1.2	1.4	-0.7	1.3	3.7	2.1	-1.4	0.2	4.2	-1.8		
ZAR	0.3	2.9	4.3	4.7	1.6	1.9	4.5	-2.1	-1.6	-0.9	2.1	1.2	-3.8	1.4	0.6	0.0	0.2	
TRY	-2.4	2.0	16.1	2.5	1.1	1.4	0.3	0.1	1.7	0.4	4.0	0.5	-5.8	0.4	-0.6	0.8	2.9	
IDR	-8.9	5.4	2.4	0.2	0.4	1.1	-2.7	-1.8	-0.4	0.4	0.0	-0.2	-1.3	0.8	-0.2	1.3	0.4	0.2
BRL	-7.1	11.9	22.4	27.4	4.0	3.5	4.8	6.4	-2.0	7.2	5.8	4.8	-5.0	-2.0	0.5	1.3		
INR	-1.0	7.3	13.5	5.4	8.5	1.5	0.9	1.7	0.4	-1.2	1.2	0.9	-2.1	0.6	0.6	5.5	1.6	-0.5
MXN	3.9	5.0	2.1	-4.9	2.3	-0.6	-1.4	-2.4	-0.3	2.4	1.7	2.1	-1.2	0.2	-0.7	0.3	0.1	
EM	-26.2	67.9	34.4	109.1	58.3	12.2	12.4	13.6	12.6	11.4	31.2	23.8	-39.1	5.7	19.1	17.3	5.8	0.0
EM ex CNY & KRW	-7.0	53.1	53.8	73.3	46.2	14.4	12.1	7.6	3.4	10.4	31.5	15.6	-25.5	4.9	3.8	12.6	5.8	0.0

Source: Central bank websites, HSBC. *For period, check [Table 1](#).

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Emerging Markets (EM): Oil prices have held steady despite mixed signals around potential Middle East negotiations, which has been supportive for EM bonds this week. The high-frequency data we track shows net inflows across regions, likely reflecting a combination of lower core yields and the appeal of EM's higher carry given easing Fed hike expectations. In our view the broad-based inflows across regions suggests a tactical reallocation towards EM, particularly given positioning had been light, rather than a structural shift in flow dynamics. Flows are likely to remain sensitive to the risk of Fed rate hikes. That being said, we think relative policy stances across emerging and developed markets would increasingly be the key driver of bond flows, rather than idiosyncratic country conditions, given still-light positioning.

Higher-frequency flow data in [Table 1](#) shows that, in the latest reported week (ending date varies across markets), non-resident investors net bought USD25m of Korean Treasury Bonds (KTBs) in the secondary market, after net selling USD2.1bn last week. Across Asia, bond inflows were also seen in Indonesia (USD267m), Thailand (Corp + Govt, USD209m), and India (Corp + Govt + SDL, USD482m). The Philippines bucked the inflow trend with a modest decrease in foreign holdings of USD6m (Govt + Corp). In LatAm, all categories of Mexico government debt saw USD591m of buying, CEEMEA saw inflows of USD132m in Turkiye.

Below, we review the latest reported flow data and key developments for certain bond markets:

Foreigner outflows in Korea turned positive this week: Foreign investors had been net sellers of KTBs since late July with the exception of month-end WGBI inclusion flows ([Chart of the week](#)). We think the main reason was a sharp move higher in the cross-currency basis, which reduced arbitrage returns. The cross-currency basis likely tightened after a large amount of USD was brought onshore following a chipmaker's ADR receipts. Thus, onshore USD liquidity increased and pushed the cross-currency swap basis higher, making total KTB returns less attractive as it eroded the arbitrage incentive. The 1Y cross-currency basis has re-risen this week to around -20bp, which is roughly 40bp above its average since January 2026. As long as the cross-currency basis remains tight, we think it will be difficult for inflows to pick up meaningfully over the near term.

Foreigner demand holds steady in Peru: Foreign investors added a further USD405m to Peru government bonds in July. Inflows were seen across all tenors. Notably, demand for bonds with maturities under 5 years returned in July, after persistent outflows since March. Overall, appetite appears to have shifted up the curve slightly: in July, the 5-10Y bucket saw the largest inflows, whereas in June the strongest inflows were concentrated in tenors longer than 10Y.

Marginal pickup in flows into SAGBs: After two months of declining inflows, July saw a modest increase in foreign buying of USD201m. Even so, foreigners' share of outstanding SAGBs was broadly unchanged at 24.7% (24.8% in June). This suggests that the additional flow is less a sign of stronger demand and more consistent with investors reinvesting maturities. By instrument type, fixed-rate SAGBs and inflation-linked bonds (ILBs) saw outflows. The pickup was largely driven by increased foreign inflows into floating-rate notes (FRNs).

Table 1: Foreign capital flows

	Total flows (weekly/ monthly/quarterly)	Last week/month/ quarter flows	4-week total flows	YTD flows [¥]	Previous year flows [¥]	Foreign holdings USDbn (LCYtrn)	Foreign ownership (% of total bonds)	As of
ASIA EX JAPAN								
KOREA (weekly data)								
Total: Government debt	103	-2560	-2583	13745#	43519	222 (KRW328) #	24.6%	12-Aug-26
KTBs	25	-2138	-2717	19110#	43504	214 (KRW316) #	25.5%	12-Aug-26
MSBs	78	-421	134	-5364#	15	8 (KRW12) #	12.4%	12-Aug-26
10yr KTB futures	44	1,846	846	8,340	-11,334	n/a	n/a	12-Aug-26
3yr KTB futures	-336	4,321	8,408	-9,927	-1,373	n/a	n/a	12-Aug-26
INDONESIA (weekly data)								
Government bonds (IndoGBs)	267	4	-39	895	181	50.4 (IDR895.61)	12.8%	10-Aug-26
THAILAND (weekly data)								
Gross purchases/selling (Corp + Govt)	209	303	#N/A	1,554	2,353	n/a	n/a	12-Aug-26
Total: Government debt	300	19	-33	1,007	1,536	28.3 (THB0.94)	7.5%	7-Aug-26
- Bonds (ThaiGBs)	240	41	-27	794	1,630	28.0 (THB0.93)	9.5%	7-Aug-26
- BoT bills	60	-22	-6	214	-93	0.3 (THB0.01)	0.4%	7-Aug-26
INDIA (weekly data)								
Total: Corp + Govt + SDL	482	-527	1,611	8,733	6,037	60.8 (INR5.79)	n/a	12-Aug-26
Government bonds	425	-372	755	8,399	5,146	47.1 (INR4.48)	3.6%	12-Aug-26
MALAYSIA (monthly data)								
Total: Government debt	995	-1,701	n/a	350	4,459	68.8 (MYR0.28)	20.6%	Jun-26
- MGS	836	-498	n/a	2,892	4,958	58.2 (MYR0.24)	33.6%	Jun-26
- MGS + MGII	648	-1,752	n/a	187	5,387	68.3 (MYR0.28)	20.6%	Jun-26
- BNMNs + T-bills	346	51	n/a	163	-928	0.5 (MYR0.00)	16.9%	Jun-26
CHINA (monthly data)								
Total: debt	-1,906	12,928	n/a	-38,112	-98,460	471.2 (CNY3.2)	1.7%	Jun-26
Policy bank bonds	-416	1,994	n/a	784	-18,022	105.8 (CNY0.72)	2.9%	Jun-26
Government bonds	1,591	9,030	n/a	1,348	-7,482	296.8 (CNY2.01)	4.7%	Jun-26
PHILIPPINES (weekly data)								
Gross purchases/sales (Corp + Govt)	-6	-78	-227	-4,603	307	n/a	n/a	12-Aug-26
Total: Government debt	-1,290	-2,103	n/a	-1,290	2,263	8.3 (PHP0.5)	4.10%	1Q26
SRI LANKA (weekly data)								
Total: Bonds	0	19	155	142	240	0.6 (LKR0.19)	1.0%	6-Aug-26
LATAM								
BRAZIL (monthly data)								
Total: Government debt (all categories of bonds, including NTN-F and LTN)	-2,021	-5,016	n/a	3,539	27,356	177.3 (BRL0.88)	10.4%	Apr-26
Bonds (NTN-F)	851	1,214	n/a	3,974	5,278	54.4 (BRL0.27)	42.6%	Apr-26
Bills (LTN)	-3,404	-5,724	n/a	-4,033	6,877	71.7 (BRL0.36)	29.7%	Apr-26
MEXICO (weekly data)								
Total: Government debt (all categories of bonds including Mbonos and Cetes)	591	62	801	2,753	-4,856	103.1 (MXN1.79)	11.3%	3-Aug-26
Bonds (Mbonos)	601	54	515	1,328	2,602	86.7 (MXN1.50)	26.3%	3-Aug-26
Bills (Cetes)	13	-188	203	1,392	-1,811	12.2 (MXN0.21)	8.4%	3-Aug-26
COLOMBIA (monthly data)								
Government debt	1,354	-1,277	n/a	-2,598	15,848	45.2 (COP154.51)	19.8%	Jun-26
PERU (monthly data)								
Government Bonds	405	322	n/a	2,442	3,748	26.2 (PEN0.09)	46.4%	Jul-26
CEEMEA								
HUNGARY (weekly data)								
Government debt (bills + bonds)	-92	308	-312	13,058	2,387	31.6 (HUF9.99)	31.1%	12-Aug-26
TÜRKİYE (weekly data)								
Government debt (bills + bonds) ^{^^}	132	955	2,411	2,228	2,518	17.3 (TRY0.82)	8.8%	31-Jul-26
SOUTH AFRICA (monthly data)								
Government bonds (nominal, inflation-linked, floating and sukuk)	201	49	n/a	2,061	4,684	66.1 (ZAR1.09)	24.7%	Jul-26
POLAND (monthly data)								
Government debt	-1,799	4,186	n/a	6,982	6,693	52.7 (PLN0.20)	13.9%	Jun-26
CZECH (monthly data)								
Government bonds	-1,116	2,178	n/a	4,664	-589	45.5 (CZK0.97)	27.2%	Jun-26
ISRAEL (monthly data)								
Government bonds	580	1,242	n/a	1,506	3,840	30.9 (ILS0.09)	10.1%	May-26

Table 1: Foreign capital flows

	Total flows (weekly/monthly/ quarterly)	Last week/month/ quarter flows	4-week total flows	YTD flows	Previous year flows	Foreign holdings	Foreign ownership	As of
DEVELOPED MARKETS								
in local currency bn								
Foreign holdings (% of total bonds)								
US (weekly data, in USDbn)								
US Treasuries (official custodial holdings)	8.5	35.5	28.1	-62.8	-196.8	2,697	n/a	5-Aug-26
TIC holding data (monthly data)**								
Total: US Treasuries	13.1	30.5	n/a	176.8	584.2	9,371.1	30.3%	May-26
Treasury bonds	56.6	50.5	n/a	171.7	439.5	7,916.0	32.8%	May-26
Treasury bills	-43.5	-20.0	n/a	5.1	144.7	1,455.1	21.5%	May-26
UNITED KINGDOM (quarterly data, in GBPbn)								
Total: Gilts	28.1	13.0	n/a	12.2	40.3	737.4	32.9%	31-Dec-25
FRANCE (quarterly data, in EURbn)								
Negotiable government debt	-4.5	13.6	n/a	-4.5	83.6	1,444.6	54.7%	31-Mar-26
ITALY (monthly data, in EURbn)								
Government debt securities	22.5	-11.7	n/a	51.7	100.8	924.2	34.9%	Apr-26
SPAIN (monthly data, in EURbn)								
Unstripped government bonds	-2.6	1.3	n/a	34.6	78.9	689.1	50.5%	May-26
JAPAN (weekly data, in JPYbn)								
Total: Government debt	559	-185	380	6,642	18,528	157,770^	13.7%	1-Aug-26
AUSTRALIA (quarterly data, in AUDbn)								
Total: Government debt	20.2	3.5	n/a	20.2	50.2	469	50.86%	1Q26
NEW ZEALAND (monthly data, in NZDbn)								
Total: Government debt	-2.2	-1.5	n/a	-0.6	14.5	118.1	55.8%	Jun-26
Total: Government bonds	-2.9	-1.0	n/a	0.2	15.3	111.3	61.1%	Jun-26
Inflation-Indexed Government Bonds	0.3	-0.4	n/a	-0.3	-0.4	4.2	23.2%	Jun-26
T-bills	0.3	-0.1	n/a	-0.3	-0.2	1.7	29.4%	Jun-26

*US Treasuries held in foreign official and international accounts.

**Overall US Treasury holding data from Treasury International Capital.

^Foreign holdings and percentage ownership data refer to 1Q26.

^^Flows data are weekly for corporate and government debt.

^^^Türkiye reporting of foreign holdings in government securities has changed as of 13 August 2021.

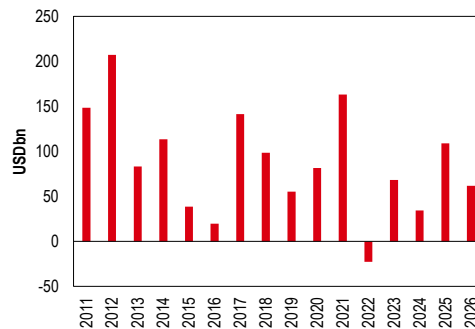
^^^^Based on gross transaction volume and does not include bond maturities.

^YTD flows and previous year flows represent the year based on date reported in the last column of the table.

^Values as of May 2026.

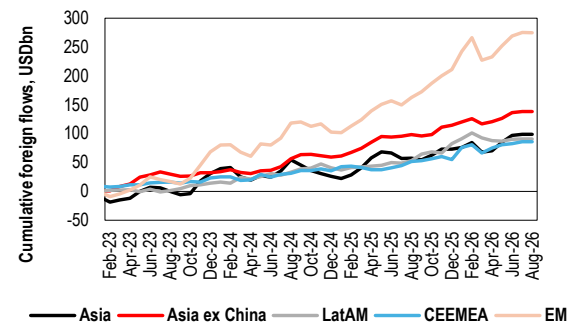
Source: Central bank websites, Bloomberg, HSBC

Figure 2. Foreign investment in EM sovereign debt



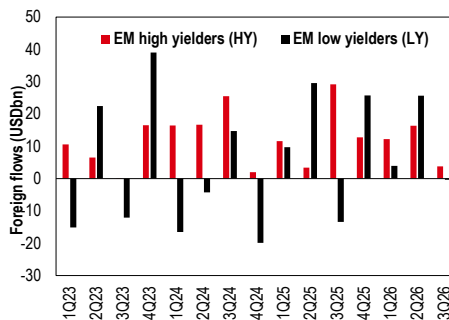
Source: investments into the 18 emerging markets mentioned on page 3. Source: Central banks, HSBC

Figure 3. Distribution of foreign flows into sovereign debt, by region



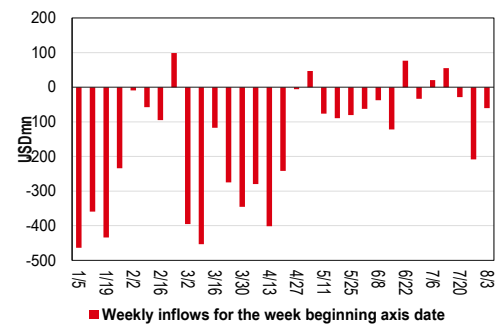
Source: Central bank websites, HSBC.

Figure 4. Distribution of foreign flows into sovereign debt, by high vs low yielders



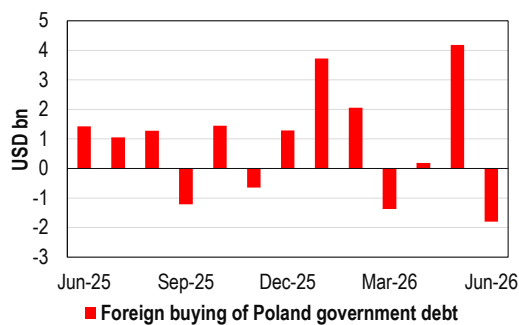
Source: Central bank websites, HSBC.

Figure 5. Outflows continued in the Philippines



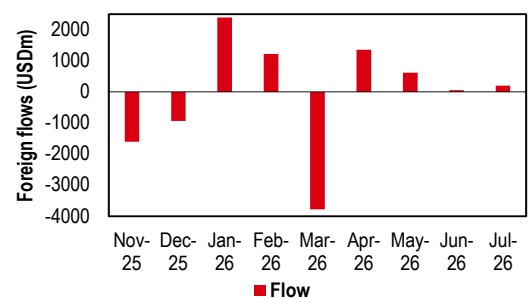
Source: PDS, HSBC

Figure 6. Foreign investors turned net sellers of PolandGBs in June



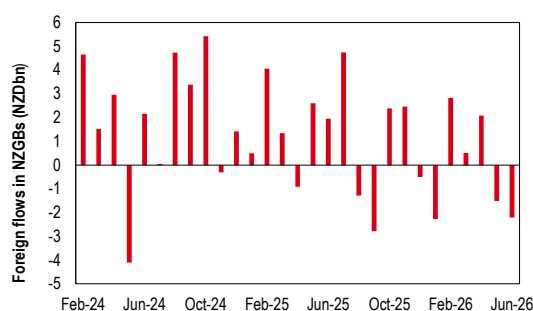
Source: RBI, CCIL, HSBC

Figure 7. Inflows into SAGBs increased in July



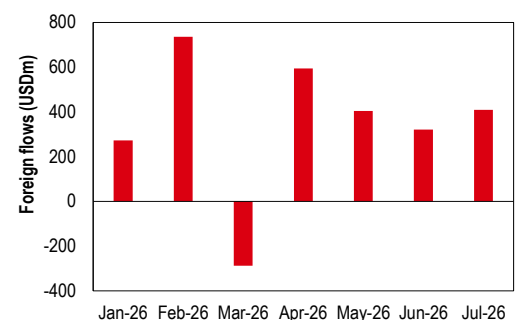
Source: National Treasury Department of South Africa, HSBC

Figure 8. Foreign investors sold New Zealand government debt in June



Source: RBNZ, HSBC

Figure 9. Non-resident investor inflows into Peruvian government debt was stable

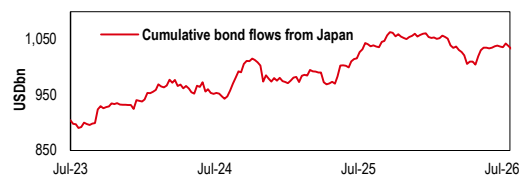


Source: MEF, HSBC

Japanese investor flows

Table 2. Weekly bond flows from Japan, up to 7 August 2026

Flows in USDbn	-1 week	YTD	Jan 2020 to Aug 2026
Net	10.3	-7.7	305.7
Out of overseas markets	46.2	1,693.8	23,619.4
Into overseas markets	56.5	1,686.2	23,925.1



Note: Includes sovereign and corporate.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC.

Table 3. Net monthly bond flows from Japan, up to 30 June 2026 by region...

(USDbn)	June 2026	2026 (YTD)	2025
Europe (EU)	6.3	2.2	12.9
North America	-5.0	-26.8	69.2
Oceania	-3.2	-5.9	1.7
EEMEA	1.3	2.9	2.6
Asia	2.0	5.8	-7.3
LatAm	0.1	-0.4	-1.1

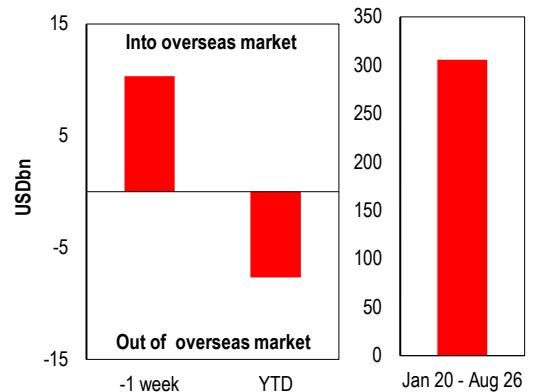
Source: Inc Sov & Corp. MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC

Table 4. ...ranked by market

(USDbn)	June 2026	2026 (YTD)	2025
U.S.A.	-4.7	-29.3	69.1
Australia	-3.2	-5.7	0.6
France	2.8	-2.2	-0.1
Korea	1.9	7.1	-0.7
U.K.	1.2	-2.2	0.4
Italy	1.2	2.7	3.3
Switzerland	0.6	0.4	-0.8
Belgium	0.5	-0.7	0.8
Finland	-0.4	-0.1	0.4
Austria	0.4	1.5	-0.7
Canada	-0.4	1.5	0.5
Germany	0.3	-1.4	1.3
Malaysia	-0.3	-0.2	0.0
Ireland	-0.2	1.5	11.7

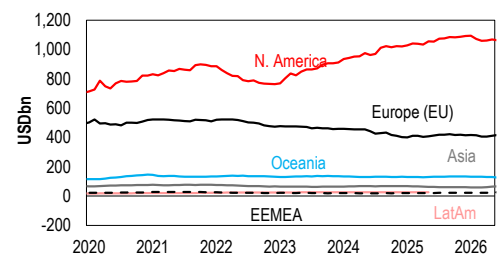
Note: Inc Sov & Corp.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC

Figure 10. Net weekly bond flows from Japan, up to 7 August 2026



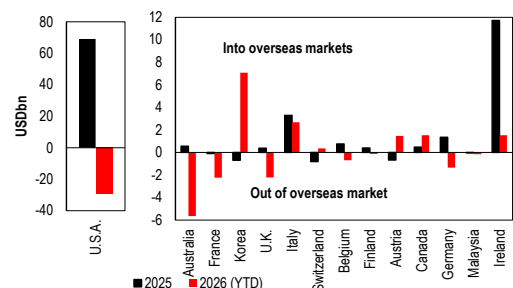
Note: Includes sovereign and corporate.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC.

Figure 11. Monthly bond flows highlight that Japanese investors bought overseas debt in June 2026



Note: Includes sovereign and corporate.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC.

Figure 12. Japanese investments in overseas debt markets



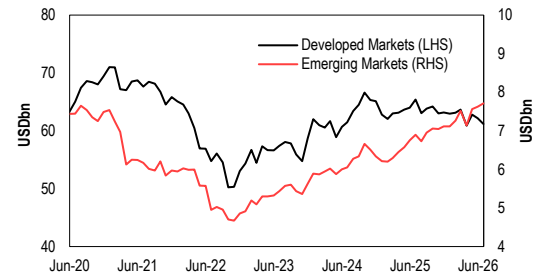
Note: Includes sovereign and corporate.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC.

Table 5. Japanese retail investors' holdings of foreign debt in June 2026

Country	Change in Japanese retail investors' foreign bond holdings (USDm)			Current holdings (USDm)
	June 2026	2026	2025	June 2026
US	-526	-1,169	-337	40,416
Euro bonds	-163	-333	279	11,696
Australia	-190	288	148	4,152
UK	8	-414	253	2,620
France	-70	-20	215	2,817
Italy	9	-41	113	2,336
Germany	-32	-88	10	2,235
China	31	310	260	2,292
Spain	-79	-91	35	1,606
Canada	-57	2	16	1,407
India	-2	-134	-57	1,099
Brazil	-38	79	127	916
New Zealand	-21	-39	-274	374
Netherlands	-12	-24	-25	594
Mexico	9	64	192	919
Belgium	2	-9	-8	515
Poland	12	40	168	601
Malaysia	-1	18	81	481
Indonesia	-6	-20	49	387
Norway	-18	-82	114	236
Thailand	0	7	33	258
South Africa	6	25	29	266
Denmark	-1	-12	-18	163
Singapore	-5	0	30	159

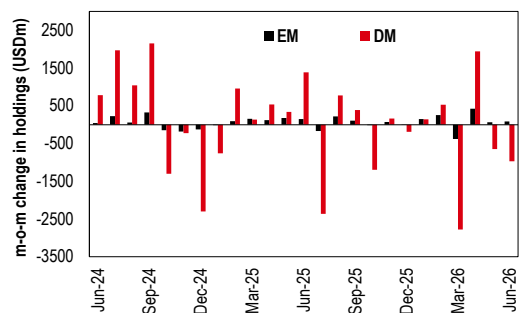
Source: Toushin funds, HSBC

Figure 13: Japanese retail investors' holdings of DM and EM debt



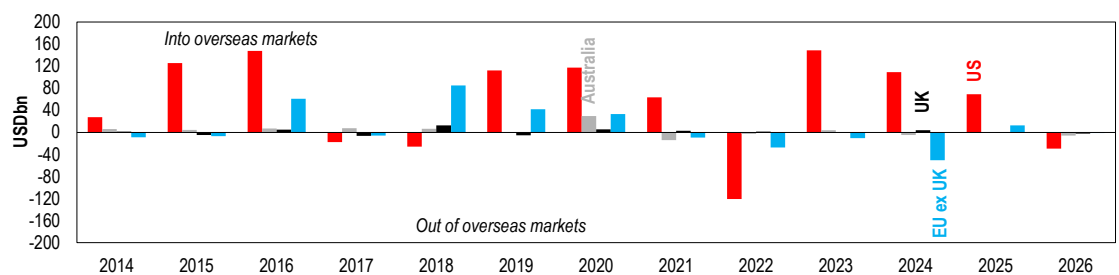
Source: Toushin funds, HSBC

Figure 14: M-o-m change in Japanese retail investors' holdings of DM and EM debt



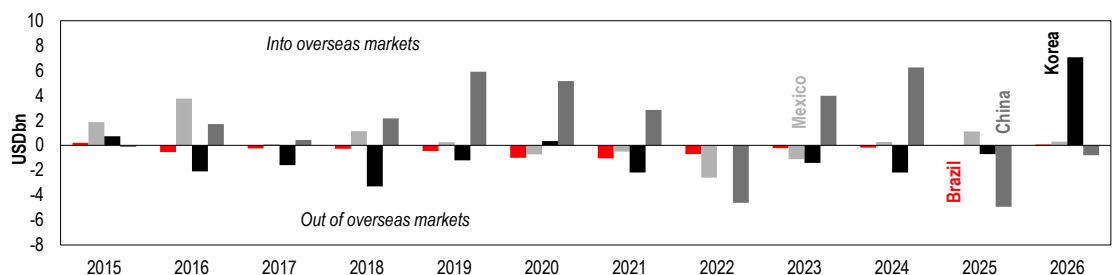
Source: Toushin funds, HSBC

Figure 15. Japanese institutional investors have sold US debt so far in 2026



Note: Includes sovereign and corporate.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC

Figure 16. Japanese institutional investors' demand for Korea government debt increased in 2026



Note: Includes sovereign and corporate.
Source: MoF, Bloomberg, HSBC

Explanatory notes

Table 1. Foreign capital flows

Based on the availability of the data (daily/weekly/monthly/quarterly frequency), foreign capital flows have been computed in USD terms as follows:

Daily flows = (Daily change in holdings in local currency)/(End of day exchange rate vs USD)

Weekly flows = (Weekly change in holdings in local currency)/(End of week exchange rate vs USD)

Monthly flows = (Monthly change in holdings in local currency)/(End of month exchange rate vs USD)

Quarterly flows = (Quarterly change in holdings in local currency)/(End of quarter exchange rate vs USD)

The annual and year-to-date foreign capital flows have been computed as a sum of periodic flows in US dollar terms (daily/weekly/monthly/quarterly).

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